surprised that our leadership's looking out for ours.

Q: Secretary Rubio, turning to geopolitics, President Putin has indicated that Russia is open to a trilateral meeting involving the US and Ukraine to discuss ending the war. What do you see as a realistic path towards ending the Russia-Ukraine conflict?

Rubio: Well, it's a very difficult conflict to end. I know the President has dedicated a tremendous amount of time to it. We have people that do nothing all day but work on trying to find a way to make a difference and bridge those differences. I would just say to you that that war, while people keep talking about it (as) a war in Ukraine, that war is about Donbas. It's about one region of the country. It is, at its core, about 11 per cent... one part of the country that Russia wants and cannot take militarily, and that Ukraine is unwilling to give up. And they have reasons why they don't want to do it—for their sovereignty and their own long-term security. And so, the question is whether both sides will make some concessions to bring an end to the war. This war is not going to be solved militarily. This war is only going to end diplomatically. And the question is, can you arrive at an outcome in which both sides receive something, a benefit, but also give concessions and bring this to an end? So, it's been difficult, but I can tell you this. As hard as it is, it is impossible to do unless both sides are at the table talking, and we're happy to play the mediating role in that regard. So, that's really what we're trying to do. Not claiming that just getting them in the room is going to solve this problem, but we have no chance to solve it if we can't get them in the room.



BANDEEP SINGH

> **"The Russia-Ukraine war won't be solved militarily, it will only end diplomatically. And it will be impossible to do unless both sides make concessions. We're happy to play a mediating role"**
>
> **— RUBIO**

Q: Ambassador Gor, you have worked very closely with President Trump. What's the secret of working successfully with the President?

Gor: Look, the President is an incredible individual. I have known him for many years. He's very direct. He expects results. He is results-driven in a similar way that your Prime Minister is. He wants to move fast, and he wants to get things done. That's something frankly I have admired about our President. Not every global leader is results-driven. A lot of people love having these press conferences and meetings after meetings after meetings. Our President wants results, and he wants them done now.

Q: And his equation with Indian prime minister Narendra Modi?

Gor: They're dear friends and it works well because of that, because they see eye to eye on moving the ball forward, on getting things done, on delivering. And so, he holds the Prime Minister in the highest regard. They've known each other for many years. They'll continue to engage. They've had multiple phone calls in this month alone. And so, a lot happens behind the scenes that people are not aware of, but the two leaders are constantly in contact.

Q: Secretary Rubio, what's your experience of working with your boss, President Trump?

Rubio: Well, he's a historic figure. There's no doubt about it. He is not an orthodox political figure. He is not a politician at all. He is a man of business whose intent in life is to make decisions based on what makes sense. But here's something else he doesn't get credit for. He's a visionary. He imagines what people will say is impossible. He thinks things that people say, "Well, we can't do it because that's never been done before." And then he achieves them. When you look at issue after issue, what the President has pushed towards and has been able to achieve that people didn't think was possible because a traditional political figure would have never done it. So, I think for those of us who work for him and with him, it gives us energy to know that we have the ability to do things that you would not be able to do under someone who came from a traditional political background. And in the case of foreign policy and in the world, and in the realm of global affairs, it's a very exciting time to be doing it.

Gor: I will add that, in the future, people will look back on these years, and our President will be one of the greatest, and also a historical figure who achieved a lot. We see it happening in real time now.

Q: Secretary Rubio, can we expect to see your name on the presidential ballot in 2028?

Rubio: I am plenty focused. I have two jobs right now and they both take up all my time and energy, and I'm very happy doing those jobs. ■